

Kyrgyzstan

Ratio: 3:5 **Adopted:** March 3, 1992 **Usage:** National and Civil

*Red is for Manas
the Noble, the
national hero*



*The sun's 40
rays stand for the
40 tribes and
40 heroes of the
Kyrgyz nation*

*A stylized yurt, the traditional
home of nomadic people*

Asia



Conquered by Russia under the tsars, in 1991 the Republic of **Kyrgyzstan** became the last of the Soviet Union Republics to declare sovereignty.

Independent since 1991, a post-communist flag was not adopted until 1992. The flag's red background is supposed to be the flag color used by the national hero, Manas the Noble, who welded 40 tribes together to form the Kyrgyz nation.

In the center of the flag is a yellow sun with 40 rays, representing the tribes and the legendary 40 heroes of Manas. The sun's rays run clockwise on the obverse of the flag and counterclockwise on the reverse.

▲ A TRADITIONAL YURT

At the sun's center is a stylized bird's-eye view of the roof, or *tunduk*, of a Kyrgyz *yurt*, the traditional tent used by the nomadic

people of the steppe. It symbolizes the unity of time and space, the origin of life, hearth and home, and the history of the nomads.

▲ ARMS OF KYRGYZSTAN

Like the arms of its neighbor, Kazakhstan, the coat of arms of Kyrgyzstan is round and does not contain a traditional shield. In the center is a white eagle with spread wings. Behind this are snow-capped mountains, representing the mighty Tien Shan and a radiant, rising sun. This scene is bordered by wreaths of cotton and wheat, both major agricultural products in Kyrgyzstan. The name of the state is inscribed in Cyrillic script at the top.